

Drew Thomas

Software engineer · Founder, Elovarra · Licensed cosmetologist

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Software engineer with seven years across regulated financial systems and greenfield product work. Currently building a multi-tenant SaaS platform end to end as its sole engineer, while delivering compliance and production engineering for a national mortgage lender. Also a practicing licensed cosmetologist, which is where the platform came from. Comfortable owning a system outright – schema through deploy through the 2am incident.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Principal Engineer · Elovarra

Feb 2026 – Present

Salon & local-services SaaS platform · Georgia, USA

- Sole engineer on a **multi-tenant SaaS platform** for salon and local-service businesses – application, data layer, background processing, deployment pipeline, and production operations.
- Built and operate the surrounding toolchain the business runs on, including **deployment tracking**, **log aggregation**, **cloud inventory**, and **double-entry accounting**.
- Shipped production **AI features on the Anthropic Claude SDK** – retrieval pipelines, embeddings, and assistant surfaces built to hold up under real use.
- Carries its own **billing and regulatory compliance** obligations. Taken from a standing start to a running platform in **six months**, concurrent with part-time consulting and weekend salon work.

Software Engineer, Consultant · CGI

Jun 2019 – Present

Client: Clayton Homes / Vanderbilt Mortgage & Finance · Knoxville, TN · Jan 2020 – Present

- Maintain and extend a **large monolithic ColdFusion application** serving a national mortgage lender, on a four-person engineering team.
- Deliver regulatory compliance work for **NMLS and HMDA** – research, remediation, and reporting corrections in a regulated consumer-lending environment.
- Own backend promotional and pricing configuration work; previously owned the **external-facing customer application**.
- Diagnose and resolve **production incidents**, including 500-level failures, across a legacy codebase where downtime carries direct financial cost.
- Reduced to **part-time in October 2024** to attend cosmetology school, and continued part-time while building Elovarra.

Client: ProAssurance · Birmingham, AL · Sep 2019 – Dec 2019

- Automated the weekly actuarial table update process in **PowerShell**, eliminating roughly **20 developer-hours of manual work per week**.
- Backfilled a departing engineer mid-project and carried a **Workday implementation** and an **accounting system modernization** to completion, onboarding into an unfamiliar regulated codebase under deadline.

Cosmetologist

2026 – Present

Joseph & Friends · Georgia · Saturdays, alongside engineering work

- Practicing stylist since licensure. A career change undertaken in earnest, and the direct source of Elovarra's product direction.

Salon Assistant · Joseph & Friends, Nov 2025 – 2026 · Jamison Shaw
Hairdressers, Jul 2025 – Nov 2025

- Worked salon floors while completing licensure hours – learning the operational realities of the business from the inside.

Cybersecurity Intern · Concilium1

Summer 2018

- Built **ServiceNow dashboards and reports** supporting security operations and client reporting.

TECHNICAL

LANGUAGES

JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, SQL, ColdFusion, Python

FRAMEWORKS

Node, React, Express, .NET, FastAPI

DATA

PostgreSQL, Redis, IBM iSeries / AS400

PLATFORM

AWS, Docker, Linux, Nginx, GitHub Actions

PRACTICE

Progressive web apps, REST APIs, CI/CD, incident response, regulatory compliance (NMLS, HMDA)

EDUCATION

BS, Management Information Systems

2019

University of Alabama

- 3.8 GPA overall; above 4.0 in major coursework.
- Led the capstone team that built and **delivered a fantasy golf application to a live external client**.
- Leadership, Association for Information Management Systems – ran the speaker series and corporate recruiting events.
- Regular community service through the honors society, including local cleanup work.

CERTIFICATIONS & SERVICE

- **AWS Certified Developer – Associate** – 2022 (lapsed)
- **Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning**, University of Texas at Austin – 2021
- **Cosmetology License**, State of Georgia – 2026

SERVICE

- Campus recruiting volunteer at CGI – university visits and candidate mentoring.
- Community volunteering close to home – the food kitchen, the town's haunted house, and the concession stand at the county fair.